

WordPress Mobile Edition

A plugin that'll format your site for mobile phone browsers, so you can make your site accessible on the go

WordPress users

Famous sites that use WordPress: Wall Street Journal Magazine, Wired Blogs, TechCrunch, The New Adventures of Mr. Stephen Fry

Smart SoHo



You can customise WordPress to work for any kind of site

you downloaded, and you'll see all the files you need inside a folder called wordpress. Rename wp-config-sample.php to wp-config.php. Open the file in any text editor, and enter your database name, username and password under "MySQL Settings".

Now use an FTP client to upload the contents of the wordpress folder to your site (if you upload the folder itself, you'd have to access the site by going to www.yoursite.com/wordpress/). Once the upload is complete, visit your site to begin installing WordPress. All you have to do now is enter a name for the site and your email address, and WordPress will give you an admin password so you can begin using your site.

Once you've got your administrator password, you can log into your site's

Dashboard, which gives you a quick overview of what's happening on the site.

How the content works

When talking about content in WordPress, we use four terms – posts, pages, categories, and tags.

Posts are the most basic units of your site: every time you add new content to the site, you do it as a post. To add a new post, go to Posts > Add New in your dashboard. You can also add excerpts to posts, which are summaries of the posts' content. On your site's main page, posts appear newest first.

Pages are similar to posts, but are for static content – an "About Us" page, for example. They fall outside the normal structure of your site, and unlike posts, don't follow the

newest-first order. You also can't put them in categories.

Categories are self-explanatory. WordPress lets you put posts in as many categories as you need, and can even put uncategorised posts in a default category you can select. To create and manage your categories, go to Posts > Categories in your dashboard. To change the default category for posts, go to Settings > Writing and change the Default Post Category.

And finally, you can add tags to posts, which are key terms that describe the posts. Search engines pick up these terms when they're crawling sites, so if you're starting a company blog, tagging your posts is always a good idea.

Without customising your theme, however, your content is still going to look like a blog.

Customising the site

As of this writing, the WordPress theme directory has 832 free themes, and counting. You can even get your hands on a premium theme for anywhere between \$5 (Rs 250) and \$100 (Rs 5,000).

Once you've found a theme you like, download and extract it to your hard disk, upload the theme folder to **wp-content/themes/** on your site, and go to Appearance in the dashboard to activate the theme. Most WordPress themes will give you one or more sidebars (which may or may not be on the sides), to which you can add widgets, such as a calendar, a list of categories, and so on. To add widgets to your sidebars, go to Appearance > Widgets,

Recommended WordPress Plugins

Ultimate Google Analytics

Track how much traffic you're getting, where that traffic is coming from, and how many sites are linking to you.

OIOPublisher

This one's paid (\$47), but might be worth it—it's an insanely advanced ad manager, even automating the ad sales process.

WP e-Commerce

Lets you turn your WordPress site into an online store.

Theme My Login

Makes registered users see a special login and profile page that matches your theme, rather than the WordPress defaults.

Breadcrumb NavXT

Lets you add breadcrumbs (Home > Category > Post, for example) to your templates.

Microkid's Related Posts

Adds related links to your posts manually, so you don't have to rely on tags or keywords to determine which posts are related.

OnePress Framework

A theme "framework", which you can use as the basis for designing an elaborate theme of your own. Nearly every area is widget-ready, and it even comes with a few widgets of its own. As a bonus, OnePress also comes with the ability to integrate your WordPress site with a phpBB forum.

is_human()

Have users verify their humanity by answering questions or solving an equation (probably the most effective way to avoid spam registrations)



Installing WordPress is a no-brainer



Default WordPress site, with a single sample post

and drag the widgets you want into the sidebars you want them in.

And when your site looks like it should, you can add plugins to make it work like it should. Installing a new plugin is as easy as the theme—download and extract it, upload the folder to wp-content/plugins/, and go to Plugins in the dashboard. To enable the plugin you just uploaded, click